SAY IT TWO WAYS

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Say each word twice. First use your careful spelling voice and sound out every syllable. Then say it the way you really say it at the dinner table. A whole syllable goes missing, and the vowel in it was a schwa. Write the vowel letter that disappeared, then cover the first column and write the word yourself.

Word	Careful voice	Everyday voice	Schwa letter	Cover and write it
1. chocolate	**CHOC · o · late** (3)	**CHOC · late** (2)		
2. camera	**CAM · er · a** (3)	**CAM · ra** (2)		
3. family	**FAM · i · ly** (3)	**FAM · ly** (2)		
4. separate	**SEP · a · rate** (3)	**SEP · rate** (2)		
5. different	**DIF · fer · ent** (3)	**DIF · rent** (2)		
6. every	**EV · er · y** (3)	**EV · ry** (2)		
7. vegetable	**VEG · e · ta · ble** (4)	**VEG · ta · ble** (3)		
8. favorite	**FA · vor · ite** (3)	**FAV · rite** (2)		

Use this when you spell. If a word looks like it has a letter you never say, say it in your careful voice: choc-**o**-late, sep-**a**-rate, veg-**e**-table. The careful voice puts the missing letter back.

Nobody is talking wrong. Dropping the schwa is normal English, not lazy speech, and every fluent speaker does it. The careful voice is a spelling tool, not a way of talking.

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SAY IT TWO WAYS ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Say each word twice. First use your careful spelling voice and sound out every syllable. Then say it the way you really say it at the dinner table. A whole syllable goes missing, and the vowel in it was a schwa. Write the vowel letter that disappeared, then cover the first column and write the word yourself.

Word	Careful voice	Everyday voice	Schwa letter	Cover and write it
1. chocolate	CHOC · o · late (3)	CHOC · late (2)	o	chocolate
2. camera	CAM · er · a (3)	CAM · ra (2)	e	camera
3. family	FAM · i · ly (3)	FAM · ly (2)	i	family
4. separate	SEP · a · rate (3)	SEP · rate (2)	a	separate
5. different	DIF · fer · ent (3)	DIF · rent (2)	e	different
6. every	EV · er · y (3)	EV · ry (2)	e	every
7. vegetable	VEG · e · ta · ble (4)	VEG · ta · ble (3)	e	vegetable
8. favorite	FA · vor · ite (3)	FAV · rite (2)	o	favorite

Use this when you spell. If a word looks like it has a letter you never say, say it in your careful voice: choc-**o**-late, sep-**a**-rate, veg-**e**-table. The careful voice puts the missing letter back.

Nobody is talking wrong. Dropping the schwa is normal English, not lazy speech, and every fluent speaker does it. The careful voice is a spelling tool, not a way of talking.

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